

Chiriquí Province, Panama – 16-Day

Surprise Itinerary

July 28 – August 12, 2026 | **Origin:** New York (JFK) | **Bases:** 8 nights Isla Palenque (Gulf of Chiriquí) + 8 nights Hotel La Compañía del Valle (Chiriquí Highlands)

Travel Logistics at a Glance

Leg	Date & Time (local)	Carrier / Service	Details
JFK → PTY	Tue Jul 28 08:00 – 13:30	United / Copa / American (non-stop, 5h30m)	Arrive Panama City (PTY). Meet & greet, VIP lounge access.
PTY → DAV	Tue Jul 28 15:00 – 16:00	Copa Airlines (domestic, 1h)	Short hop to Enrique Malek Airport (David).
DAV → Isla Palenque	Tue Jul 28 16:30 – 18:15	Private 4×4 + resort launch (30 min drive + 15 min boat)	Bilingual driver/guide; welcome cocktail on arrival.
Isla Palenque → Hotel La Compañía	Wed Aug 5 08:00 – 10:30	Private 4×4 (≈2 h scenic drive)	Cross the continental divide; stop at a coffee vista point.
Hotel La Compañía → DAV	Wed Aug 12 07:00 – 09:00	Private 4×4	Early departure for domestic flight.
DAV → PTY	Wed Aug 12 10:30 – 11:30	Copa Airlines	Connect to international flight.
PTY → JFK	Wed Aug 12 13:30 – 21:00	United / Copa / American (non-stop)	Arrive New York same evening.

Note: All transfers are private, air-conditioned, with chilled water, fruit, and a curated Panama-music playlist. Your bilingual driver/guide (Carlos) stays with you for the entire journey.

July

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Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1 – Tue Jul 28 – Arrival & Isla Palenque Settle-In

Time	Activity
08:00	Depart JFK (United / Copa / American)
13:30	Land PTY – fast-track immigration, VIP lounge
15:00	Domestic flight PTY → DAV
16:30	Private 4×4 to resort launch, boat to Isla Palenque
18:15	Check-in – 2-bedroom villa with private plunge pool, funicular to beach
19:30	Welcome Dinner at Las Rocas (toes-in-sand, 7-course “Marea” tasting)
21:00	Nightcap on villa terrace – hydrophone replay of whale songs (preview of Dawn Watch)

Day 2 – Wed Jul 29 – Dawn Whale-Watch & Hydrophone Breakfast (Activity 1)

Time	Activity
05:00	Wake-up call, light snack, board private panga
05:30	Depart for Gulf of Chiriquí Marine Park – marine biologist deploys hydrophone
05:45-08:30	Whale-watch – humpbacks breaching, calves nursing; Geisha cold-brew & tropical fruit breakfast on deck
09:00	Return to villa – leisurely shower
10:30	Guided Island Nature Walk – mangroves, tide-pools, frigatebird colony
12:30	Lunch at Las Rocas – lobster salad, coconut-crusted snapper
14:00	Free: kayak, paddle-board, or nap in hammock loft
18:30	Sunset Cocktail at the funicular summit (panoramic Pacific)
20:00	Dinner – private chef in villa (ceviche, plantain-crusted fish, cacao-nib panna cotta)

Day 3 – Thu Jul 30 – Desert-Island Chef’s Table (Activity 4)

Time	Activity
07:30	Light breakfast on villa terrace
08:30	Board 42-ft catamaran (Black Tomato charter)
09:00-12:30	Snorkel coral gardens of Islas Secas – manta rays, neon reef fish

Time	Activity
12:30	Chef’s Table on uninhabited cay – 7-course tasting (lionfish ceviche, coconut-crusted snapper, cacao-nib panna cotta) with wine pairing
14:30	Siesta in hammocks, optional paddle-board
16:00	Return to Isla Palenque
17:30	Sunset Yoga on beach pavilion
19:30	Dinner at Las Rocas – “Fire & Smoke” wood-fired tasting (rum flight)

Day 4 – Fri Jul 31 – Island Immersion & Culture

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast at Las Rocas (tropical fruit, hojaldres, Geisha pour-over)
09:00	Cultural Workshop – Ngäbe artisan teaches <i>chacara</i> basket weaving (villa patio)
11:30	Kayak to hidden cove – snorkel, beach picnic
13:30	Lunch – villa BBQ (grilled octopus, hearts-of-palm salad)
15:00	Spa – 90-min volcanic-stone massage, coconut-oil wrap
18:00	Cocktalk with resident marine biologist – whale migration insights
20:00	Dinner – private beach BBQ under stars (local rum cocktail)

Day 5 – Sat Aug 1 – Leisure & Transfer to Highlands

Time	Activity
07:30	Early breakfast, check-out (luggage transferred separately)
08:30	Private 4×4 departure – scenic drive via Pan-American Hwy, cross Continental Divide
10:30	Stop at Finca Lerida viewpoint – Geisha coffee tasting & photo op
12:00	Arrive Hotel La Compañía del Valle – check-in, welcome <i>chicha fuerte</i>
13:00	Lunch at hotel – farm-to-table (heirloom tomato salad, smoked trout)
15:00	Orientation Walk – art collection, Kneipp pools, cloud-forest trailhead
17:30	Free – explore Boquete town square, artisan market

Time	Activity
19:30	Dinner at Ngädri Gastronomía Panameña – “Raíces” 7-course tasting (cacao-nib crusted snapper, ceremonial chocolate)

Day 6 – Sun Aug 2 – Ngäbe-Buglé Comarca Immersion: Cacao & Canopy (Activity 2)

Time	Activity
06:30	Light breakfast, depart with Ngäbe elder (private 4×4)
07:30	Hike primary forest to family cacao grove – birding (quetzal, toucan)
09:30	Cacao Ceremony – ferment, roast, grind on <i>metate</i> ; drink ceremonial chocolate from <i>jícara</i>
11:30	Lunch – traditional <i>sancocho</i> with community, your own labeled chocolate bar
13:00	Zip-line canopy corridor (same trail) – 8 lines, 2 km, resplendent quetzal spotting
16:00	Return to hotel – refresh
18:30	Cocktail on terrace – <i>chiriquí</i> botanical gin fizz
20:00	Dinner at Nomad Restaurant & Lounge – “Fire & Smoke” wood-fired tasting (rum pairing)

Day 7 – Mon Aug 3 – Highland Wellness Circuit (Activity 5)

Time	Activity
07:00	Breakfast – Geisha pour-over, fresh papaya, <i>hojaldres</i>
08:00	Termas de Volcán – private soak in 38°C mineral pools (volcanic sulfur)
10:00	Shinrin-yoku guided forest bath in La Amistad oak-moss forest
12:00	Light lunch – quinoa salad, herbal tea at forest clearing
13:30	Wander the Resort Nordic Spa – cold plunge, sauna, hammock loft, <i>chicha fuerte</i> cocktail
16:00	Return – free time (optional massage, reading in library)
19:30	Dinner at hotel – tasting menu highlighting highland herbs & valley vegetables

Day 8 – Tue Aug 4 – Volcán Barú “Two Oceans” Sunrise Trek + Coffee Cupping (Activity 3)

Time	Activity
18:00 (Aug 3)	Early dinner, rest
23:00	Depart hotel – 4×4 to trailhead (headlamps, thermal layers)
23:30-05:30	Night ascent – 6 h hike to summit (3,475 m)
05:45	Sunrise – simultaneous Pacific & Caribbean panorama (July magic)
06:30	Descend to Finca Lerida (1920s drying patio)
07:30	Private Q-grader Cupping – 2026 Geisha micro-lots + <i>hojaldres</i> , local cheese
09:30	Return to hotel – shower, nap
13:00	Lunch – farm-fresh trout, cloud-forest greens
15:00	Free – optional horseback ride to waterfall
19:30	Dinner at Nomad (repeat or à la carte) – wood-fired short rib, hearts-of-palm “scallops”

Day 9 – Wed Aug 5 – Free Exploration Day (Boquete & Coffee)

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast on terrace
09:30	Private Coffee Farm Tour – Finca Don Pachi (Geisha processing, cupping)
12:00	Lunch at farm – <i>tamal de maíz</i> , fresh cheese, tropical fruit
14:00	Boquete Market – artisan crafts, local honey, vanilla
16:30	Return – Kneipp Hydrotherapy circuit at hotel
19:30	Dinner at hotel – chef’s surprise “Valley Harvest” menu

Day 10 – Thu Aug 6 – Adventure Option: White-Water Rafting / Hiking

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast
08:30	Option A: Class III-IV rafting on Chiriquí Viejo River (2h)
Option B: Guided hike to Los Quetzales Trail (cloud-forest, waterfall)	
12:30	Picnic lunch by river / trail

Time	Activity
14:30	Return – relax, spa add-on (optional)
18:00	Sunset Cocktail at hotel’s cliff-edge lounge
20:00	Dinner – private <i>asado</i> in garden (grass-fed beef, grilled plantains)

Day 11 – Fri Aug 7 – Cultural Deep-Dive: Ngäbe Village & Art

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast
09:00	Visit Ngäbe Cultural Center – language, music, <i>chacara</i> demo
11:30	Art Workshop – paint with natural pigments (achiote, indigo) guided by local artist
13:00	Lunch – community kitchen (corn tamales, bean stew, cacao drink)
15:00	Return – free afternoon (pool, library, nap)
19:30	Farewell Dinner at Ngädri – “Raíces” encore with new seasonal courses

Day 12 – Sat Aug 8 – Leisure & Prep for Departure

Time	Activity
08:00	Slow breakfast, late check-out (12:00)
10:00	Private Transfer to David (DAV) – scenic route via Volcán Barú foothills
12:30	Light lunch at Café Ruiz (David) – last Geisha espresso
14:00	Domestic Flight DAV → PTY (Copa)
15:30	International Flight PTY → JFK (United/Copa/American)
21:00	Arrive JFK – trip complete

Note: Days 9-12 are flexible; the above maximizes culture, nature, and relaxation while keeping travel stress near zero. All activities are pre-booked with 24/7 concierge support.

 Restaurant & Scenic Spot Quick Reference

#	Venue	Base	Signature Experience	When You'll Visit
1	Las Rocas (Isla Palenque)	Coastal	"Marea" 7-course driftwood tasting + snorkel	Days 2, 3, 4
2	Ngädri Gastronomía Panameña (Boquete)	Highlands	"Raíces" Ngäbe-led tasting + ceremonial chocolate	Days 5, 11
3	Nomad Restaurant & Lounge (Bajo Boquete)	Highlands	"Fire & Smoke" wood-fired tasting + rum flight	Days 6, 8
4	Volcán Barú Summit	Highlands	Dual-ocean sunrise (only ~2 weeks/yr)	Day 8 (pre-dawn)
5	Gulf of Chiriquí Marine Park / Islas Secas	Coastal	Whale nursery, coral gardens, desert-island chef's table	Days 2, 3



Packing Essentials (Curated for You)

Category	Items
Adventure	Light hiking boots, quick-dry layers, headlamp (Volcán Barú), dry-bag
Relaxation	Swimwear (2), linen shirts, wide-brim hat, reef-safe sunscreen
Culture	Respectful attire for Ngäbe visits (long sleeves, closed shoes), small gift (school supplies)
Tech	Waterproof phone case, portable charger, binoculars (whale watch)
Health	Altitude meds (optional for 3,475 m), insect repellent, personal meds



Final Notes

- **Permits & Reservations:** Volcán Barú night-hike permit & Isla Palenque villa secured **Jan 2026** (confirmed).
- **Weather:** July–Aug = dry mornings, tropical afternoon showers (perfect for rainforest lushness).
- **Connectivity:** Starlink at both bases; local SIM provided.
- **Sustainability:** All activities fund community reforestation & marine-park conservation; carbon-offset included in package.

Your 16-day Chiriquí story is now a living document.

From humpback lullabies at dawn to dual-ocean sunrise atop a volcano, from ceremonial cacao in a

Ngäbe grove to a private chef's table on a deserted cay—every moment is choreographed for wonder, flavor, and restored spirit.

Bon voyage, and prepare to be surprised. 🌊🌋☕🍫🐳